Red Bull

WHAT I CAN BRING

Music partnerships that turn Red Bull's cultural relevance into revenue.

Red Bull is already in music, and its cultural equity opens every door. I propose a more commercially viable way to use it.

Portfolio ↗ | CV ↗ | LinkedIn ↗

Prepared by
Caroline Kelly

Prepared for
Red Bull partnerships

Date
October 2026











WHY MUSIC

Red Bull is already ingrained in music, and it is the natural next fit

In the car, on the slopes or out on a run, I always have music on. **Every Red Bull moment, right up to a world record, has a soundtrack.**



EMOTION SELLS

+5.0%

Cadbury sales the month Gorilla aired, set to Phil Collins's drums

IPA, 2008 · Watch it ↗



ONE MOMENT, ONE SONG

2,049%

jump in Jade's US streams after Kylie Jenner walked to Angel of My Dreams. Labels want moments like that.

Spotify via Nylon, Oct 2026

EVERY STUNT NEEDS A SONG

$641m

paid to put music in films, ads and games in 2025. Red Bull makes all three, and labels want those placements

IFPI Global Music Report, 2026

ALREADY KNOWS THE INDUSTRY

21 years

of Red Bull Music Academy (1998 to 2019), plus 18 running its own label, Red Bull Records (2007 to 2025)

Rolling Stone, 2019; Digital Music News, 2025

And the drink fits the crowd: 32% of 16 to 24 year olds in England don't drink (HSE, 2024), so a night out with music and Red Bull suits them.



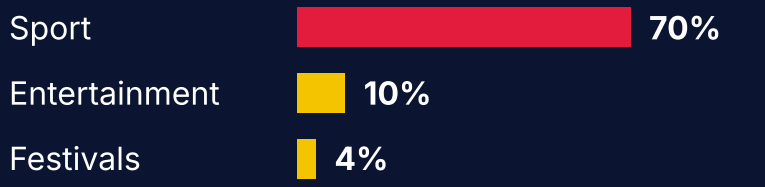
MUSIC IS A SPORT IN ITSELF

Making music, touring with a band and setting up a festival all take energy and passion. That is why it fits Red Bull.

THE MARKET

Music is growing on live events Red Bull already puts on, so it should reap the rewards of its patronage

WHERE NORTH AMERICAN SPONSORSHIP WENT (ESP, 2018)



SPONSORSHIP OF SINGLE SPORTS, 2025 (SPONSORUNITED)



BUSINESS IS BOOMING

$198.1bn

music revenue by 2035, up from $112.5bn in 2025 (Goldman Sachs, 2026)

LIVE IS TRENDING

$145.8bn

music by 2030, and live experiences are now social currency (PwC, 2026)

MOMENTS GO VIRAL

52%

of fans find music on social, 73% of Gen Z. Red Bull moments push awareness, a sell to labels (Deloitte, 2026)

BRANDS ARE MISSING OUT

$641m

sync income in 2025, down 2.0%, so brand money in music is still small (IFPI, 2026)

YOUNG PEOPLE LOVE LIVE

37%

of Gen Z went to 2+ concerts, up from 29%. Red Bull's events add new fans for little extra spend (Luminate, 2026)

ARTISTS NEED BACKING

43%

of UK musicians earn under £14k from music (Musicians' Census, 2023)

Method: I read each report in full on 22 Oct 2026 and logged the figure, year and scope, comparing growth rather than mixing totals.

RED BULL'S MUSIC HISTORY

Red Bull already built the connections, so it doesn't need to start again to reach these fans

Programme	Years	What it left Red Bull with
Music Academy	1998 to 2019	4,000+ applied for New York, 2013
BC One	2004 to now	2009 final sold out in 30 minutes
Red Bull Records	2007 to 2025	AWOLNATION's "Sail", US diamond
Culture Clash	2010 to 2025	2025 at Drumsheds, London
Notting Hill Carnival	2013 and 2017	Rodigan sound system, Mangrove

+8.6%
turnover, €12.2bn

+10.2%
cans, 13.97bn

+15%
marketing, €3.15bn

€0.23
marketing per can

Sources: Red Bull profile, 2025; trend., 2026; DMN, 2025; Rolling Stone, 2019. Per can is my division of 2025 totals.



Partner with a label instead of becoming one

An independent label already signs, releases and sells the music. Red Bull would fund the moments around a release, bring its reach and put the can in the room. After 18 years of running a label it knows how the industry works and how not to be taken for granted, without taking that responsibility on again.

Beggars Group is my case study, and the same method works for any label.

THE ANALYSIS

I ran the data analysis and the market research myself

Data analysis

73 artists, 53 on Beggars labels and 20 comparators. I collected their streaming data from APIs and public data, built loyalty and growth scores in Python and stress-tested them. Beggars Group is my case study, and the method works for any label.

Python · Spotify Web API · Chartmetric · 11 tests passing

Market research

I read the industry reports in full, from Goldman Sachs, PwC, Deloitte, IFPI and Luminate, and logged every figure with its source and year.

Reports read 22 Oct 2026

THE PROCESS

01 Pick the artists

02 Collect the data

03 Score in Python

04 Test it

05 Read the market

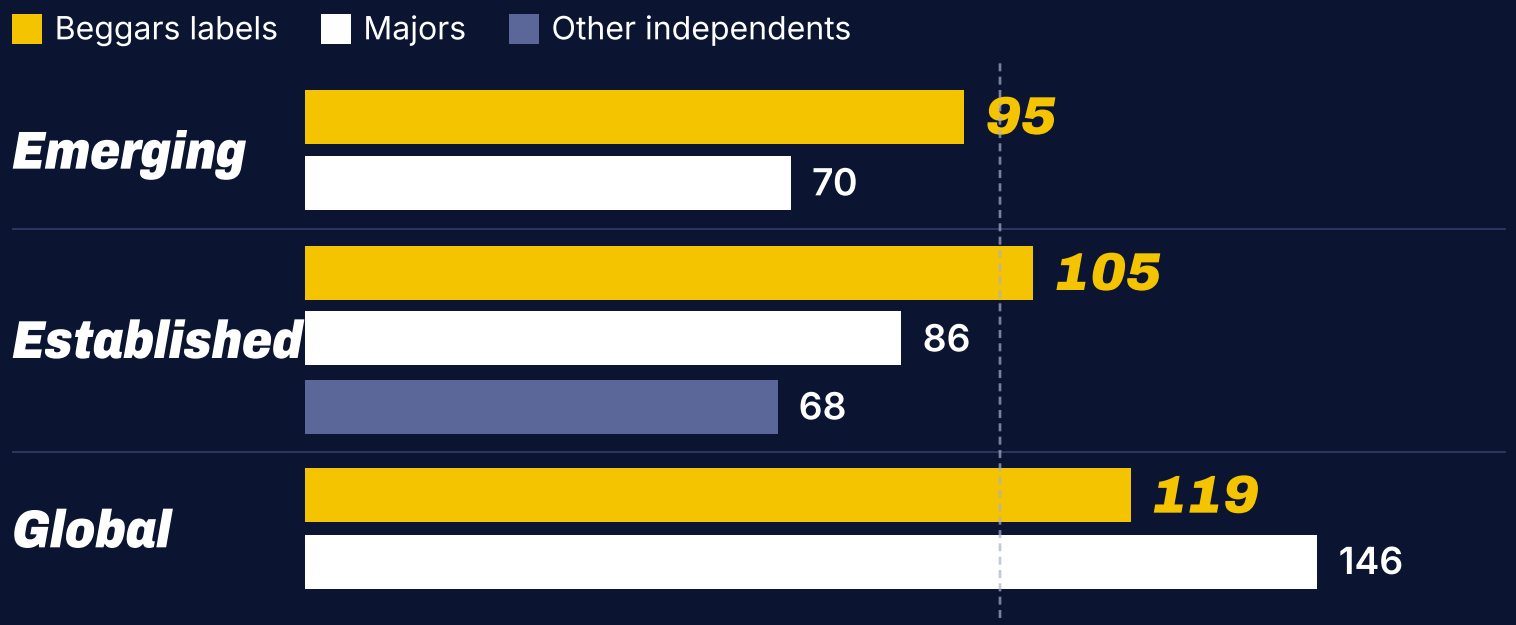
06 Report it straight

THE ANALYSIS

CASE STUDY: BEGGARS GROUP

Beggars acts keep more of their listeners as fans, until they reach the global tier

LOYALTY INDEX, MEDIAN BY TIER (MEDIAN ACT = 100)



Chartmetric snapshot and Spotify Web API, 15 Oct 2026, 53 Beggars acts and 20 comparators (notebook 03).

HOW TO READ IT

I plotted Spotify followers against monthly listeners and fitted a line. Acts above it turn more listeners into followers than their size predicts. The median act scores 100.

TEAM UP WITH AN INDEPENDENT LABEL

Independent labels have passionate fans but not Red Bull's marketing or audience. I used Beggars Group as my case study, home to XL, 4AD, Rough Trade, Matador and Young, and the same method works for any label. Partnering lets Red Bull reach a passionate local audience on a global scale, without the cost of running its own label again.

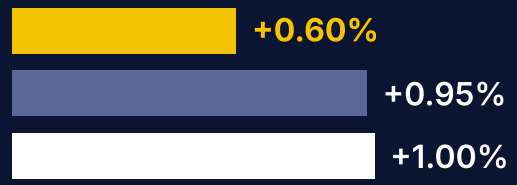
SO WHAT FOR RED BULL

Followers come back for the next release and the next show, so a loyal fan base gives a partnership something to build on.

THE ANALYSIS | CASE STUDY: BEGGARS GROUP

The loyal fans are already there, and Red Bull's reach can bring the growth

GROWTH RED BULL CAN ADD



Median 30-day change in Spotify followers to 15 Oct 2026, Chartmetric.

LOYAL FANS TO WIN

r = –0.48

So what for Red Bull: the most loyal acts grow more slowly, so reach is the missing piece, and Red Bull has it in 178 countries.

FANS ALREADY WORLDWIDE

80 to 100%

of top-three-country YouTube views come from abroad for most of nine acts, against about 10% for Brentford's fans.





RIP MAGIC CAR MEET · OCT 2026

THE KIND OF NIGHT RED BULL CAN PULL OFF

An album played through modded car systems at a south-east London meet. Monthly listeners rose by more than half around it. Red Bull already runs the kind of events artists would die to play at.

40.0K to 62.6K
monthly listeners

+63%
playlist reach

Chartmetric, 24 Sep to 20 Oct 2026 · See the night ↗

WAYS IN

Three ways in: unique venues, label sync and cultural events



YHWH NAILGUN, 2026

Host amazing artists in unique venues

Shows in places fans have never been inside, like the Marble Arch courtyard closed since 2009, with Red Bull making the night possible. Watch the NTS Session ↗



STUNT FILMS

Partner with labels on sync

Red Bull is always breaking records. Put a label artist's track on the next stunt film: the artist gets huge exposure, and Red Bull is part of the making of the song.



NOTTING HILL CARNIVAL

Partner with cultural events

Red Bull brought a sound system to Carnival in 2013. Carnival gets no core funding from central government or Arts Council England, so a partner makes a real difference to over a million people.

A LOW-COST FIRST PILOT: ONE LABEL, ONE RELEASE

Red Bull already has the event teams, sound systems, venues, its media house to film it, and the cans.

New spend is the artist's fee, permits and a small production budget, at the scale of a free show like YHWH Nailgun's.

The artist: streams and followers before and after, against 20 comparator acts

The crowd: attendance, session views and sign-ups, agreed with the act

The can: release-week sales against matched areas, using Red Bull or Circana data

The bar: every €1m spent needs about 1.15m extra cans sold to earn it back in sales (my calculation)

THE SUMMARY

The change: Red Bull goes from backing music to partnerships that sell cans

	NOW	THE GAP	HOW I'D FILL IT → WHAT RED BULL GETS
Money	Sport takes about 70% of sponsorship; the NFL alone earned $2.66bn in 2025	Music holds the audience: 37% of Gen Z go to two or more concerts	Bespoke partnerships around releases, tours and festivals → **Red Bull owns the moments fans remember**
Red Bull	Marketing rose 15% to €3.15bn in 2025, and the brand opens any door	Its academy, radio and label have closed	Partner with an independent label → **Back in music without running a label**
Artists	43% of UK musicians earn under £14k a year	Loyal fans, but they need reach to grow	Unique venues, label releases and cultural events → **Red Bull's reach brings artists new fans**
Proof	No Red Bull music programme publishes its link to can sales	Nobody measures the artist, crowd and can together	I measure every moment against comparators → **Each partnership shows what it sold**

Sources: ESP, 2018; SponsorUnited, 2025; Luminate, 2026; Red Bull accounts via trend., 2026; Musicians' Census, 2023; my analysis, Oct 2026.

WHAT I BRING

I find the artists, prove the value and measure what sells

Red Bull already runs so many cultural experiences that use music. It should benefit from that reach, and I can turn it into partnerships that sell cans.

01 **Find the right artists and fans**
My fan platform joined 4,827 fans of five artists from four platforms

02 **Read the market around them**
Goldman Sachs, PwC, Deloitte, IFPI and Luminate, read for this pitch

03 **Pick the partners most likely to sign**
My Williams Racing model's top 10% held 84% of future sponsors

04 **Measure the artist, the crowd and the can**
I tracked 926 opportunities to 38 signed deals and found what doubled closures

05 **Be in the room with the artists**
Artist liaison at the Attitude Awards at the Roundhouse and Rolling Stone UK

I'M PASSIONATE | I'M ENTHUSIASTIC | I DECIDE WITH DATA



Making music, touring and putting on a festival is a sport in itself.

THE ASK

Let me help on your next music partnership

Caroline Kelly, a data analyst who loves music, with an MSc in Business Analytics from UCL.

Open my CV ↗

See my portfolio ↗

Connect on LinkedIn ↗